

ATS & Resume Optimization Guide

Knowledge Base Handbook for AI Resume Analyzer

1. Understanding ATS

An Applicant Tracking System (ATS) is software used by employers to collect, organize, and rank resumes. Modern ATS platforms scan resumes for relevant keywords, section headings, education, experience, and technical skills before a recruiter reviews them. Understanding how ATS works helps candidates create resumes that are both machine-readable and recruiter-friendly.

Key points:

- Use standard headings such as Education, Skills, Projects, Experience.
- Save resumes as PDF unless another format is requested.
- Include keywords naturally from the job description.
- Keep formatting simple and readable.

2. Building an ATS-Friendly Resume

A strong resume should contain clear contact information, a concise professional summary, technical skills, education, projects, certifications, and achievements. Place the most relevant information near the top. Use bullet points instead of long paragraphs. Highlight measurable achievements wherever possible.

3. Resume Keywords

Recruiters search for job-specific keywords. Match the terminology used in the job description. Include programming languages, tools, frameworks, certifications, and domain knowledge. Avoid keyword stuffing—keywords should appear naturally within your experience and projects.

4. Resume Formatting Best Practices

Use professional fonts such as Calibri or Arial between 10–12 pt. Maintain consistent spacing and margins. Avoid graphics, icons, tables, text boxes, and multiple columns because many ATS systems cannot parse them correctly. Use bold section headings for readability.

5. Common Resume Mistakes

Common issues include spelling mistakes, generic objectives, inconsistent formatting, missing technical skills, lack of quantified achievements, outdated contact details, and including irrelevant information. Always proofread and tailor your resume for every application.

6. ATS Checklist & Summary

Checklist:

- Standard headings
- Tailored keywords
- Action verbs
- Quantified achievements
- Professional formatting
- Relevant projects
- Certifications
- No tables or graphics

Final Takeaway:

An ATS-friendly resume increases the likelihood of passing the initial screening while remaining easy for recruiters to read. Focus on clarity, relevance, and measurable impact.